



Brilliant Lady: Hosted Solo Group

November 30 – December 10, 2026 · Hosted by Tina Maulsby

Ship: Virgin Voyages Brilliant Lady · **Sailing from:** Miami, PortMiami Terminal V · **Cabin:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#): the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers the ship, each port, packing, budget, emergency contacts and the group.

Day by day

Times are from Virgin Voyages' itinerary page for this voyage, read October 2026. **Check them in the Virgin Voyages app before you sail.** All aboard is one hour before departure (Virgin's rule).

#	Date	Port	In port	All aboard	Worth knowing
1	Mon Nov 30	Miami: boarding	ship leaves 5:00 PM	your app arrival time	Terminal V. Fly in Sunday. Sailaway meetup: watch the group chat.
2	Tue Dec 1	At sea	—	—	Book dinners and Shore Things in the app.
3	Wed Dec 2	At sea	—	—	Spa, fitness classes, the group.
4	Thu Dec 3	St. Maarten (Philipsburg)	8:00 AM – 6:00 PM	5:00 PM	About 10 minutes' walk to town. Taxi to Maho Beach \$25 for one or two.
5	Fri Dec 4	Tortola, BVI	9:00 AM – 6:00 PM	5:00 PM	A long day. Cane Garden Bay by taxi, or Virgin Gorda as a Shore Thing. Passport needed.
6	Sat Dec 5	St. Croix, USVI	8:00 AM – 6:00 PM	5:00 PM	Docks at Frederiksted. Fort Frederik \$5. Buck Island boats leave from Christiansted.
7	Sun Dec 6	San Juan, Puerto Rico	8:00 AM – 5:00 PM	4:00 PM	El Morro and San Cristóbal \$10, card only. The earliest all-aboard.
8	Mon Dec 7	Puerto Plata, DR	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM	6:00 PM	Taíno Bay, by the old town (port's schedule). Cable car closed for rebuild.
9	Tue Dec 8	At sea	—	—	Settle your account in the app.
10	Wed Dec 9	Bimini Beach Club, Bahamas	9:00 AM – 6:00 PM	5:00 PM	Free tram from the dock. Food, soda, pools and Wi-Fi included; cocktails extra.
11	Thu Dec 10	Miami: home	arrive 6:30 AM	—	Allow up to an hour for the gangway. Book a flight after midday.

Book through Maulsby Travel Co. to be in the group: [Tina Maulsby](#), tina@maulsbytravel.com, 910-528-5077. **Flyer solo prices:** Interior \$1,715 · Balcony \$2,316 (can change until you book).

Gratuities: for bookings from October 7, 2025, Virgin adds \$22 per person per night (\$20 if pre-paid). **Ask Tina** whether they're in your fare, which Wi-Fi level you have, and whether your interior is a Solo Insider.

Passport: Virgin asks for one valid six months past the cruise, so through **June 10, 2027**.

Weather, in one line: Warm in the islands (highs 81 to 84°F), milder in Miami (78°F) and Bimini (76°F). Puerto Plata is the wettest stop, with rain on more than half these days. Averages for November 30 to December 10, 2020 to 2024, not a forecast. Hurricane season officially ends November 30, the day you sail.

Getting to the ship and getting home

Sunday arrival, Monday boarding

Sunday, November 29: fly in. It's the Sunday after Thanksgiving, so book early.

Monday, November 30: boarding.

- **Terminal V**, 718 N. Cruise Blvd. For GPS, Virgin says to enter 1015 North America Way, Miami, FL 33132.
- **Parking:** PortMiami's Garage G, \$25 a day (PortMiami, October 2026).
- **Arrival:** pick a terminal arrival time in the app and don't come earlier. Luggage drop opens at 9:00 AM.
- **From the airport:** about 9 miles. Taxis are metered, \$15 minimum.
- **Carry-on:** passport, medications, swimsuit, change of clothes, charger.

Thursday, December 10: home

- The ship is due in at 6:30 AM. Allow up to an hour for the gangway to open.
- Keep your passport, medications and a change of clothes with you.

Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship

- **Rojo by Razzle Dazzle:** tapas, on Brilliant Lady only.
- **Every restaurant is included**, except a few “Treat Yourself” items and the paid dinner shows (Another Rose and It’s a Ship Show).
- **The Galley:** the food hall. An easy place to eat alone.
- **Soda and water are included.** Drinks are pay-as-you-go or a pre-paid Bar Tab. There are no drink packages.
- **Solo meetups:** Virgin runs an Evening Meet-Up, a Morning Meet-Up and a “Let’s Set Sail” event. Check the app.
- **Scarlet Night:** Virgin’s red-themed party night. Pack something red if you like.

Port-day picks (one each)

- **St. Maarten:** Great Bay beach and the boardwalk, walking distance from the port and free.
- **Tortola:** Cane Garden Bay (\$10 to \$16 per person by taxi each way, per a 2026 travel guide).
- **St. Croix:** Fort Frederik and a walk around Frederiksted.
- **San Juan:** El Morro. Bring a card, and be back by 4:00 PM.
- **Puerto Plata:** the old town and Fortaleza San Felipe.
- **Bimini:** a beach day at the Beach Club, all included except cocktails.

The group

Tina’s flyer promises a host just for the group, group dining each night, daily meetups, optional group shore excursions, a private group chat, and games and surprises. Nothing is required. Go to the first dinner and see.

The one-page emergency handoff card is a separate document. The full Voyage Pack covers everything here in more depth. Soli Deo Gloria.